

INTERNAL AUDIT PROCESS

5 Phases of an Internal Audit

Phase	What Happens	Output	GreenLeaf Example
1. Planning	Define the scope, objective, and criteria. Identify the controls to be audited.	Audit Plan & Checklist	You planned to audit A.8.13 (Information Backup) against GreenLeaf's policy.
2. Evidence Collection	Request and review evidence (logs, screenshots, interviews). Determine if evidence meets the criteria	Evidence Log & Working Papers	You requested backup logs, cloud screenshots, and testing reports from IT manager.
3. Findings	Compare evidence against criteria, identify gaps (Non conformities)	Non-Conformity Report (NC)	NC-001 (Cloud Bucket Empty, NC-002 (No Testing in 6 Months)
4. Reporting	Present findings to management. Include severity (Major/Minor) and recommended actions	Audit Report (resented to CEO)	The formal report stating that GR-003 was a major NC and required immediate action
5. Remediation & Closure	Track the implementation of corrective actions. Verify the Fix. Close the NC the unresolved	Closure Verification	It was recommended to a 48-Hour cloud migration. Once completed, you would verify and close NC-001

Phase	Analogy
1. Planning	"Planning a trip – where are we going and what do we need?"
2. Evidence Collection	"Packing your suitcase – gathering what you need."
3. Findings	"Checking your bags at the airport – do they meet the rules?"
4. Reporting	"Telling your friend about the trip – sharing the highlights."
5. Remediation & Closure	"Putting your souvenirs away – closing the journey."